

time I met Cinderella at Disney World when I was 4 or attending my cousin's bat mitzvah in Israel when I was 10? The problem is that I had a great childhood. It was just one we couldn't afford.

My sister Cheyanne is three years younger than me. On an episode of my podcast, she told me that while I was hyperaware of our family's money problems, she simply didn't realize we had them. If my sister asked my parents for money and they gave it to her, then how bad could things *really* be? I must just be paranoid. It wasn't until she was in college that my parents first told her they couldn't afford to give her money anymore.

To her credit, she went out and got a job at a restaurant—and she's had several since. (My favorite was a train-themed grill, the Midtown Caboose, in Tallahassee, Florida.) A couple years ago, having moved to LA to be near me, she had two jobs: one as a hostess and one as a personal assistant. She now works in marketing for a porn company.

There are a few luxuries she insists on. Living alone is one. Weed is the other. When I asked her if instead she might want to put that money into savings, she laughed. "Sure, yeah. Maybe. But come on. It's legal here." Would you deny a working woman the equivalent of a glass of cabernet at the end of the night? Lay off her about the weed.

I'm envious of her commitment to comfort. The reason I brought her on the podcast was to confront her. A few months before we recorded the episode, I'd loaned Cheyanne a good chunk of money to pay her bills: \$1,000. It was an emergency, she said. She had called me crying. She wasn't going to be able to make rent, even with my parents' help, and also pay her gas, water, and electric bills. I had some extra income that month, and she both thanked me and apologized to me in a flip-flop of desperation. A few hours after I transferred her the money, she posted a photo of her latest purchase: \$40 worth of sushi.

"I wanted to treat myself," she said when I brought it up, completely calm and not at all defensive. I informed her that you can't treat yourself with someone else's money.